

Coding stars

Computing is driven forward every day by millions of programmers all around the world, but every now and then someone special comes along and takes a massive leap. Here are a few of the most famous coders.

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Ada Lovelace

Nationality: British

Dates: 1815–52

Famous for: Ada Lovelace is considered to be the first computer programmer. In 1843, she published the first program for Charles Babbage's Analytical Engine (a proposed early computer). She also suggested methods for representing characters as numbers.

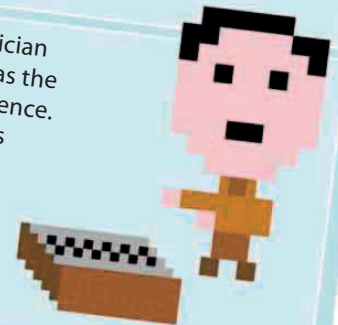


Alan Turing

Nationality: British

Dates: 1912–54

Famous for: Mathematician Alan Turing is known as the father of computer science. He's also famous for his ground-breaking work cracking secret German codes during World War II for the British.

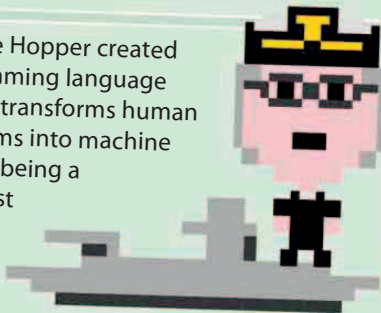


Grace Hopper

Nationality: American

Dates: 1906–92

Famous for: Grace Hopper created the first programming language compiler (which transforms human readable programs into machine code). As well as being a computer scientist she was a Rear Admiral in the US Navy!



Bill Gates and Paul Allen

Nationality: American

Dates: Gates 1955–present, Allen 1953–present

Famous for: Bill Gates and Paul Allen founded Microsoft together in the 1970s. They invented some of the most popular programs ever, such as Microsoft Windows and Office.

